

Tripods

First of all let us take a quick look at the construction of tripods. The basic parts of all tripods are fairly straightforward, with three collapsible telescoping legs and another similar section on the top that can be lowered or raised, and the head on the top containing the camera mount and various joints and handles that allow a camera to rotate, tilt or pan. The mounting head usually includes a thumbscrew which couples to a female receptor located on the vast majority of cameras, and maybe integrated with the tripod or be a separate part altogether. The most common types of tripod heads are pan-tilt heads and ball heads. If you are shooting at moving subjects or want to quickly point the camera freely in nearly any direction before

locking it into position, ball heads should be used, which make use of a

A Tripod lets you take a steadier shot



Lens Collor for mounting a lens on a tripod/monopod

simple ball and socket joint to allow movement of all axes of rotation from a single point. If you want to independently control each of the camera's two axes of rotation (left/right and up/down), it is better to go in for a pan-tilt head. These are most useful once the camera has been carefully leveled and the composition needs to be shifted slightly. While using ball heads, the advantage of free motion can also be a disadvantage because when you unlock the camera's position, it may cause your composition to no longer be level while trying to alter a single axis of rotation.

Another important part of the tripod